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Pre-Sentencing Personal History Worksheet

Help your lawyer tell the court who you are, not just what you did.

Before sentencing, your lawyer builds a picture of you as a whole person. Judges have discretion, and what they know about your life can matter. Most people hand their lawyer almost nothing, because no one told them what to gather. This worksheet is that list. Fill it in honestly, then give it to your attorney. The more real detail you provide, the stronger your mitigation.

Take your time. Some of these questions are hard. Answer the ones you can, leave the rest, and come back.

Basic facts

Full legal name: _____

Date of birth: _____

Places you have lived (most recent first):

Family and people who depend on you

Judges consider who is affected by a sentence. List the people who rely on you and how.

Children (names, ages, who cares for them):

Others who depend on you:

Who would be hurt most if you are away, and how:

Work and contribution

Employment history:

Military, volunteer, caregiving, or community roles:

Health

Physical or mental health conditions and any treatment:

Your own history

Hardship, trauma, or loss the court should understand:

What you have done to address what happened:

What you want the judge to understand about you:

Letters of support

List people who might write a character letter: employers, mentors, faith leaders, family.

Possible letter writers:

This workbook is educational and reflects lived and professional experience. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Laws and procedures vary by jurisdiction and change over time. For advice about your situation, consult a licensed attorney in your state.

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